



Two Decisions, One Story Teaching Bundle

Grade 3 • North Carolina • Mathematics

NC.3.OA.8 • Represent and solve two-step stories.

A focused classroom collection: task cards, five warm-ups, classwork, an exit ticket, four seasonal practice sets, substitute lessons, and planning pages. Each section has worked answers.

PRINT • TEACH • REVISIT



Your teaching route

Focus

Represent and solve two-step stories. This bundle practices a focused part of NC.3.OA.8; it is not a complete grade curriculum or a simulated EOG.

Before teaching

Learners should explain a simpler example using a model. Read the two worked examples, then use the first task card to check readiness.

Suggested sequence

Day 1: model for 10 minutes, then guided task cards for 15 minutes. Day 2: a 5-minute warm-up and 20 minutes of practice. Use the exit ticket to choose a small-group reteaching focus. Seasonal sets revisit the same skill using different quantities.

Materials

Pencils, blank paper, and graph paper or counters as useful. No paid app or internet is needed for student work. A calculator may check finished calculations; these are instructional choices, not official testing accommodation rules.



Make the reasoning visible

Name what each operation finds. Solve the first question before using its answer in the second step.

Example 1: The art club has 4 packs of 3 cards and then uses 2 cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

First $4 \times 3 = 12$. Then $12 - 2 = 10$.

Example 2: The community center has 9 packs of 3 cards and then receives 4 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

First $9 \times 3 = 27$. Then $27 + 4 = 31$.

Ask: What does each number represent? How could a model or inverse operation check the result?

Task cards 1–4

Read, represent, solve, and explain. Record full reasoning on the response page or separate paper.

CARD 01

The reading group has 3 packs of 5 cards and then uses 2 cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

Explain your method.

CARD 02

The design team has 4 packs of 5 cards and then receives 5 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

Explain your method.

CARD 03

The reading group has 3 packs of 7 cards and then uses 3 cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

Explain your method.

CARD 04

The library team has 3 packs of 2 cards and then receives 6 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

Explain your method.

Task cards 5–8

Read, represent, solve, and explain. Record full reasoning on the response page or separate paper.

CARD 05

The school garden has 4 packs of 4 cards and then uses 2 cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

Explain your method.

CARD 06

The science club has 2 packs of 5 cards and then receives 4 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

Explain your method.

CARD 07

The music club has 6 packs of 6 cards and then uses 2 cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

Explain your method.

CARD 08

The music club has 6 packs of 2 cards and then receives 4 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

Explain your method.



Task cards 9–12

Read, represent, solve, and explain. Record full reasoning on the response page or separate paper.

CARD 09

The science club has 8 packs of 5 cards and then uses 3 cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

Explain your method.

CARD 10

The art club has 9 packs of 7 cards and then receives 3 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

Explain your method.

CARD 11

The school garden has 9 packs of 8 cards and then uses 2 cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

Explain your method.

CARD 12

The reading group has 6 packs of 8 cards and then receives 6 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

Explain your method.



Task cards 13–16

Read, represent, solve, and explain. Record full reasoning on the response page or separate paper.

CARD 13

The school garden has 5 packs of 8 cards and then uses 7 cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

Explain your method.

CARD 14

The school garden has 9 packs of 3 cards and then receives 3 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

Explain your method.

CARD 15

The community center has 8 packs of 3 cards and then uses 4 cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

Explain your method.

CARD 16

The reading group has 4 packs of 4 cards and then receives 6 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

Explain your method.

Task-card response record

Use this page for final answers; attach drawings or full worked solutions on separate paper.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____
11. _____
12. _____
13. _____
14. _____
15. _____
16. _____

Warm-up • Day 1

Work for about five minutes. Compare one method with a partner. Complete unfinished reasoning during review.

1. The music club has 9 packs of 5 cards and then uses 4 cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

2. The reading group has 7 packs of 7 cards and then receives 5 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.



Warm-up • Day 2

Work for about five minutes. Compare one method with a partner. Complete unfinished reasoning during review.

3. The design team has 5 packs of 7 cards and then uses 6 cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

4. The reading group has 2 packs of 3 cards and then receives 3 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.



Warm-up • Day 3

Work for about five minutes. Compare one method with a partner. Complete unfinished reasoning during review.

5. The science club has 3 packs of 2 cards and then uses 6 cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

6. The reading group has 9 packs of 6 cards and then receives 2 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.



Warm-up • Day 4

Work for about five minutes. Compare one method with a partner. Complete unfinished reasoning during review.

7. The reading group has 8 packs of 2 cards and then uses 4 cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

8. The school garden has 2 packs of 4 cards and then receives 4 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.



Warm-up • Day 5

Work for about five minutes. Compare one method with a partner. Complete unfinished reasoning during review.

9. The community center has 2 packs of 4 cards and then uses 4 cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

10. The science club has 8 packs of 8 cards and then receives 5 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.



Classwork • Represent and explain

Show your thinking with a drawing, equation, or explanation. Use the space under each question.

1. The library team has 7 packs of 3 cards and then uses 3 cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

2. The design team has 5 packs of 8 cards and then receives 7 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

3. The music club has 3 packs of 2 cards and then uses 7 cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.



Classwork • Represent and explain

Show your thinking with a drawing, equation, or explanation. Use the space under each question.

4. The library team has 3 packs of 8 cards and then receives 4 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

5. The science club has 9 packs of 2 cards and then uses 2 cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

6. The art club has 7 packs of 4 cards and then receives 5 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.



Exit ticket • Try independently

Complete the four questions independently. Show enough reasoning for your teacher to see your method. This is a classroom check, not a standardized score.

1. The design team has 5 packs of 3 cards and then uses 5 cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

2. The science club has 5 packs of 2 cards and then receives 4 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

3. The science club has 7 packs of 4 cards and then uses 4 cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

4. The science club has 4 packs of 7 cards and then receives 2 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.



Task-card worked solutions

1. 13

First $3 \times 5 = 15$. Then $15 - 2 = 13$.

2. 25

First $4 \times 5 = 20$. Then $20 + 5 = 25$.

3. 18

First $3 \times 7 = 21$. Then $21 - 3 = 18$.

4. 12

First $3 \times 2 = 6$. Then $6 + 6 = 12$.

5. 14

First $4 \times 4 = 16$. Then $16 - 2 = 14$.

6. 14

First $2 \times 5 = 10$. Then $10 + 4 = 14$.

Task-card worked solutions

7. 34

First $6 \times 6 = 36$. Then $36 - 2 = 34$.

8. 16

First $6 \times 2 = 12$. Then $12 + 4 = 16$.

9. 37

First $8 \times 5 = 40$. Then $40 - 3 = 37$.

10. 66

First $9 \times 7 = 63$. Then $63 + 3 = 66$.

11. 70

First $9 \times 8 = 72$. Then $72 - 2 = 70$.

12. 54

First $6 \times 8 = 48$. Then $48 + 6 = 54$.

Task-card worked solutions

13. 33

First $5 \times 8 = 40$. Then $40 - 7 = 33$.

14. 30

First $9 \times 3 = 27$. Then $27 + 3 = 30$.

15. 20

First $8 \times 3 = 24$. Then $24 - 4 = 20$.

16. 22

First $4 \times 4 = 16$. Then $16 + 6 = 22$.

Warm-up worked solutions

1. 41

First $9 \times 5 = 45$. Then $45 - 4 = 41$.

2. 54

First $7 \times 7 = 49$. Then $49 + 5 = 54$.

3. 29

First $5 \times 7 = 35$. Then $35 - 6 = 29$.

4. 9

First $2 \times 3 = 6$. Then $6 + 3 = 9$.

5. 0

First $3 \times 2 = 6$. Then $6 - 6 = 0$.

6. 56

First $9 \times 6 = 54$. Then $54 + 2 = 56$.

Warm-up worked solutions

7. 12

First $8 \times 2 = 16$. Then $16 - 4 = 12$.

8. 12

First $2 \times 4 = 8$. Then $8 + 4 = 12$.

9. 4

First $2 \times 4 = 8$. Then $8 - 4 = 4$.

10. 69

First $8 \times 8 = 64$. Then $64 + 5 = 69$.

Classwork worked solutions

1. 18

First $7 \times 3 = 21$. Then $21 - 3 = 18$.

2. 47

First $5 \times 8 = 40$. Then $40 + 7 = 47$.

3. -1

First $3 \times 2 = 6$. Then $6 - 7 = -1$.

4. 28

First $3 \times 8 = 24$. Then $24 + 4 = 28$.

5. 16

First $9 \times 2 = 18$. Then $18 - 2 = 16$.

6. 33

First $7 \times 4 = 28$. Then $28 + 5 = 33$.

Exit-ticket worked solutions

1. 10

First $5 \times 3 = 15$. Then $15 - 5 = 10$.

2. 14

First $5 \times 2 = 10$. Then $10 + 4 = 14$.

3. 24

First $7 \times 4 = 28$. Then $28 - 4 = 24$.

4. 30

First $4 \times 7 = 28$. Then $28 + 2 = 30$.

Fall • Skill revisit

Complete four questions per sitting, about 15–20 minutes. Review the worked examples if needed. Explain one answer to a classmate or adult.

1. The fall garden club has 8 packs of 4 cards and then uses 7 cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

2. The September art display has 8 packs of 5 cards and then receives 2 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

3. The September art display has 6 packs of 8 cards and then uses 5 cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

4. The autumn reading fair has 3 packs of 5 cards and then receives 3 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.



Fall • Skill revisit

Complete four questions per sitting, about 15–20 minutes. Review the worked examples if needed. Explain one answer to a classmate or adult.

5. The leaf observation team has 9 packs of 4 cards and then uses 4 cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

6. The leaf observation team has 8 packs of 8 cards and then receives 4 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

7. The September art display has 4 packs of 4 cards and then uses 6 cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

8. The autumn reading fair has 2 packs of 3 cards and then receives 4 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.



Fall • Worked solutions

1. 25

First $8 \times 4 = 32$. Then $32 - 7 = 25$.

2. 42

First $8 \times 5 = 40$. Then $40 + 2 = 42$.

3. 43

First $6 \times 8 = 48$. Then $48 - 5 = 43$.

4. 18

First $3 \times 5 = 15$. Then $15 + 3 = 18$.

Fall • Worked solutions

5. 32

First $9 \times 4 = 36$. Then $36 - 4 = 32$.

6. 68

First $8 \times 8 = 64$. Then $64 + 4 = 68$.

7. 10

First $4 \times 4 = 16$. Then $16 - 6 = 10$.

8. 10

First $2 \times 3 = 6$. Then $6 + 4 = 10$.

Winter • Skill revisit

Complete four questions per sitting, about 15–20 minutes. Review the worked examples if needed. Explain one answer to a classmate or adult.

1. The indoor garden project has 5 packs of 5 cards and then uses 3 cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

2. The December art display has 6 packs of 7 cards and then receives 4 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

3. The December art display has 5 packs of 4 cards and then uses 3 cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

4. The indoor garden project has 8 packs of 7 cards and then receives 6 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.



Winter • Skill revisit

Complete four questions per sitting, about 15–20 minutes. Review the worked examples if needed. Explain one answer to a classmate or adult.

5. The indoor garden project has 4 packs of 8 cards and then uses 4 cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

6. The indoor garden project has 3 packs of 2 cards and then receives 5 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

7. The winter reading club has 2 packs of 5 cards and then uses 4 cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

8. The January puzzle club has 8 packs of 8 cards and then receives 4 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.



Winter • Worked solutions

1. 22

First $5 \times 5 = 25$. Then $25 - 3 = 22$.

2. 46

First $6 \times 7 = 42$. Then $42 + 4 = 46$.

3. 17

First $5 \times 4 = 20$. Then $20 - 3 = 17$.

4. 62

First $8 \times 7 = 56$. Then $56 + 6 = 62$.

Winter • Worked solutions

5. 28

First $4 \times 8 = 32$. Then $32 - 4 = 28$.

6. 11

First $3 \times 2 = 6$. Then $6 + 5 = 11$.

7. 6

First $2 \times 5 = 10$. Then $10 - 4 = 6$.

8. 68

First $8 \times 8 = 64$. Then $64 + 4 = 68$.

Spring break • Skill revisit

Complete four questions per sitting, about 15–20 minutes. Review the worked examples if needed. Explain one answer to a classmate or adult.

1. The March art display has 4 packs of 2 cards and then uses 5 cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

2. The spring book swap has 3 packs of 6 cards and then receives 5 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

3. The March art display has 7 packs of 8 cards and then uses 6 cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

4. The March art display has 7 packs of 6 cards and then receives 7 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.



Spring break • Skill revisit

Complete four questions per sitting, about 15–20 minutes. Review the worked examples if needed. Explain one answer to a classmate or adult.

5. The spring book swap has 8 packs of 7 cards and then uses 7 cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

6. The spring book swap has 3 packs of 6 cards and then receives 2 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

7. The March art display has 5 packs of 7 cards and then uses 2 cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

8. The March art display has 7 packs of 8 cards and then receives 5 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.



Spring break • Worked solutions

1. 3

First $4 \times 2 = 8$. Then $8 - 5 = 3$.

2. 23

First $3 \times 6 = 18$. Then $18 + 5 = 23$.

3. 50

First $7 \times 8 = 56$. Then $56 - 6 = 50$.

4. 49

First $7 \times 6 = 42$. Then $42 + 7 = 49$.



Spring break • Worked solutions

5. 49

First $8 \times 7 = 56$. Then $56 - 7 = 49$.

6. 20

First $3 \times 6 = 18$. Then $18 + 2 = 20$.

7. 33

First $5 \times 7 = 35$. Then $35 - 2 = 33$.

8. 61

First $7 \times 8 = 56$. Then $56 + 5 = 61$.



Summer • Skill revisit

Complete four questions per sitting, about 15–20 minutes. Review the worked examples if needed. Explain one answer to a classmate or adult.

1. The community garden has 3 packs of 8 cards and then uses 3 cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

2. The July puzzle camp has 5 packs of 3 cards and then receives 4 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

3. The community garden has 6 packs of 4 cards and then uses 3 cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

4. The June art workshop has 6 packs of 4 cards and then receives 6 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.



Summer • Skill revisit

Complete four questions per sitting, about 15–20 minutes. Review the worked examples if needed. Explain one answer to a classmate or adult.

5. The June art workshop has 4 packs of 3 cards and then uses 6 cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

6. The June art workshop has 3 packs of 6 cards and then receives 6 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

7. The community garden has 2 packs of 7 cards and then uses 3 cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

8. The June art workshop has 3 packs of 2 cards and then receives 5 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.



Summer • Worked solutions

1. 21

First $3 \times 8 = 24$. Then $24 - 3 = 21$.

2. 19

First $5 \times 3 = 15$. Then $15 + 4 = 19$.

3. 21

First $6 \times 4 = 24$. Then $24 - 3 = 21$.

4. 30

First $6 \times 4 = 24$. Then $24 + 6 = 30$.

Summer • Worked solutions

5. 6

First $4 \times 3 = 12$. Then $12 - 6 = 6$.

6. 24

First $3 \times 6 = 18$. Then $18 + 6 = 24$.

7. 11

First $2 \times 7 = 14$. Then $14 - 3 = 11$.

8. 11

First $3 \times 2 = 6$. Then $6 + 5 = 11$.

Substitute lesson

Before students arrive

Locate the class schedule, seating plan, emergency procedures, and approved learner supports from the school. This academic packet does not replace those school-specific instructions.

0-5 minutes: settle

Read the goal aloud: Represent and solve two-step stories. Let students explain a familiar strategy to a partner.

5-15 minutes: model

Use the worked-example page. Name what each operation finds. Solve the first question before using its answer in the second step.

15-30 minutes: practice

Distribute the next practice page. Students solve independently first, then compare one explanation in pairs. If copying is unavailable, read one question at a time and allow drawings or oral responses.

30-40 minutes: discuss

Use the following key. Ask students to locate the first step where methods diverged; invite a correction supported by a model.

40-45 minutes: handover

Collect one explanation from each student. On the planning page, record which step needs reteaching, who requested help, and what was completed. Use neutral observations, not diagnostic labels.

Substitute lesson • Practice

Show your thinking with a drawing, equation, or explanation. Use the space under each question.

1. The library helpers has 6 packs of 2 cards and then uses 5 cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

2. The student design group has 3 packs of 4 cards and then receives 6 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

3. The library helpers has 5 packs of 5 cards and then uses 7 cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

4. The classroom supply team has 8 packs of 6 cards and then receives 7 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.



Substitute lesson • Worked solutions

1. 7

First $6 \times 2 = 12$. Then $12 - 5 = 7$.

2. 18

First $3 \times 4 = 12$. Then $12 + 6 = 18$.

3. 18

First $5 \times 5 = 25$. Then $25 - 7 = 18$.

4. 55

First $8 \times 6 = 48$. Then $48 + 7 = 55$.

Emergency substitute lesson

Before students arrive

Locate the class schedule, seating plan, emergency procedures, and approved learner supports from the school. This academic packet does not replace those school-specific instructions.

0-5 minutes: settle

Read the goal aloud: Represent and solve two-step stories. Let students explain a familiar strategy to a partner.

5-15 minutes: model

No copies or devices? Write the first worked example on the board; students use blank paper. Name what each operation finds. Solve the first question before using its answer in the second step.

15-30 minutes: practice

Distribute the next practice page. Students solve independently first, then compare one explanation in pairs. If copying is unavailable, read one question at a time and allow drawings or oral responses.

30-40 minutes: discuss

Use the following key. Ask students to locate the first step where methods diverged; invite a correction supported by a model.

40-45 minutes: handover

Collect one explanation from each student. On the planning page, record which step needs reteaching, who requested help, and what was completed. Use neutral observations, not diagnostic labels.

Emergency substitute lesson • Practice

Show your thinking with a drawing, equation, or explanation. Use the space under each question.

1. The classroom book group has 8 packs of 3 cards and then uses 6 cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

2. The classroom book group has 9 packs of 7 cards and then receives 2 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

3. The desk-supply team has 5 packs of 2 cards and then uses 5 cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

4. The desk-supply team has 7 packs of 6 cards and then receives 4 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.



Emergency substitute lesson • Worked solutions

1. 18

First $8 \times 3 = 24$. Then $24 - 6 = 18$.

2. 65

First $9 \times 7 = 63$. Then $63 + 2 = 65$.

3. 5

First $5 \times 2 = 10$. Then $10 - 5 = 5$.

4. 46

First $7 \times 6 = 42$. Then $42 + 4 = 46$.

A completed lesson-plan example

Level and focus

Grade 3; NC.3.OA.8; Represent and solve two-step stories.

Evidence of learning

Student represents the quantities, selects a valid method, calculates accurately, and explains the result with appropriate units.

Launch / model

Use worked example 1. Ask students to annotate the role of every quantity. Demonstrate the model before moving to symbols.

Guided / independent practice

Use cards 1-4 in pairs; assign classwork independently. Change grouping according to the explanation you hear rather than speed alone.

Formative check

Use the four-question exit ticket. Score each item 0-2: 2 for an accurate result with coherent reasoning, 1 for a sound method with a minor error or an unexplained correct result, 0 for missing or unsupported reasoning.

Next teaching decision

0-3 points: reteach with a concrete model. 4-6: correct the specific misconception with a short example. 7-8: invite a second representation or a student-created problem. These are local instructional decisions, not mastery cutoffs validated by a test publisher.

Plan your next lesson

Date, class, and focus / exact local standard:

What will students do to show understanding?

Launch and worked example:

Guided practice and independent task:

Access supports and extension:

Exit evidence and next lesson decision:



Access, sources, and classroom license

AIG: Invite two methods, a counterexample, or a new task with a specified solution. Ask students to explain limits of a shortcut.

504: Apply the student's plan: breaks, extra time, enlarged print, reduced copying, or alternate response methods as documented.

EC: Use the IEP to select supports. Model one step, offer counters or a diagram, reduce the visible item set, and accept an oral explanation when appropriate.

ESL: Preview quantity, difference, factor, or other relevant terms. Let students rehearse in a home language, then use "I chose ___ because ___." Maintain the mathematical goal.

Official alignment sources • accessed September 15, 2026

NC.3.OA.8 is verified in the NCDPI mathematics progression. The activity objective is original wording; it describes the skill focus, not the full standard text.

NCDPI mathematics standards:

<https://www.dpi.nc.gov/documents/publications/catalog/ma196-vertical-progression-math/open>

NCDPI EOG mathematics specifications:

<https://www.dpi.nc.gov/documents/accountability/testing/eog/eog-mathematics-grades-3-8-test-specifications>

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